

HISTORY BATTLEFIELD TOUR

COURSE TEXTBOOK

Enquiry: Thursday 1st October – Saturday 3rd October 2026

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L1: Pre-Trip Information

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

10th Sep

Parent Briefing Meeting

16:15 in the School Hall. Attendance is highly recommended to receive final itineraries and ask any questions.

1. Pre-Trip Briefing

Please ensure all pupils have the following items packed in a suitable overnight bag (no hard suitcases if possible, to maximize coach storage space):

- **Valid Passport** (will be given in hopefully at the parent briefing meeting on the 10th of September)
- **GHIC / EHIC Card** (valid and in-date)
- **Sturdy Walking Boots** or waterproof shoes (we will be walking through muddy trenches)
- **Waterproof Coat** (Belgian weather is unpredictable)
- **Small Rucksack** for daytime use on the coach
- **Euro Currency** (approx €30-€50 maximum for snacks and chocolates)
- **Refillable Water Bottle**

L2: Day 1: Thursday 1st October 2026

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

06:15

Departure from School

Travel via Jet Connect executive coach to Folkestone.

22:00

Curfew & Room Checks

All students in rooms for the night.

11:20

Eurotunnel Crossing

Transit to Calais (clocks go forward 1 hour).

13:00

Depart Calais

Coach journey to the Ypres Salient.

19:15

Study & Reflection Session

Guided review and workbook completion.

16:00

Hooge Crater Museum & Trenches

Museum visit focusing on First World War artefacts, preserved trenches, and field medicine.

[Visit official website.](#)

14:30

Essex Farm Cemetery & Dressing Station

Historical introduction to wartime medical care and Commonwealth war graves.

09:00

Folkestone Eurotunnel Terminal

Check-in and security boarding.

20:15

Supervised Free Time

Downtime in communal areas.

15:15

Langemarck German Military Cemetery

Guided visit exploring the contrasting design of German burial sites.

18:15

Evening Meal

Dinner followed by room allocation and settling in.

17:45

Arrival at Peace Village

Accommodation check-in and safety briefing. [View hostel details](#).

1. Day 1 Itinerary

The Ypres Salient was a bulge in the Allied frontline that surrounded the Belgian town of Ypres. Because it was a salient, British and Commonwealth troops were surrounded by German artillery on three sides, making it one of the most dangerous places on earth. Ypres was the last major Belgian town not to fall to the Germans, making it a powerful symbol of resistance.

Key Facts:

- Over half a million soldiers died defending a strip of land barely ten miles wide.
- The Salient consisted of thick, heavy clay that, when bombarded by artillery, turned into a deadly, bottomless mud.
- Five major battles were fought here between 1914 and 1918.

Written Source:

"I am no longer an artist interested and curious, I am a messenger who will bring back word from the men who are fighting to those who want the war to go on for ever. It is unspeakable, godless, hopeless."

— **Paul Nash**, British War Artist (1917)



Lt Col John McCrae, author of *In Flanders Fields*

Essex Farm served as an Advanced Dressing Station (ADS). Medical officers worked in cramped, concrete dugouts just hundreds of yards from the fighting to stabilize the wounded before they could be evacuated to hospitals further back.

Key Facts:

- Triage was practiced here: sorting casualties based on the severity of their wounds.
- In May 1915, Canadian surgeon Lt Col John McCrae wrote the famous poem *In Flanders Fields* while stationed here after burying his friend Alexis Helmer.
- Valentine Joe Strudwick, one of the youngest casualties of the war at just 15 years old, is buried here.

Unlike the bright, white Portland stone of British cemeteries, German cemeteries like Langemarck are intentionally somber, shaded by large oak trees and featuring dark stone blocks, reflecting Germanic mourning traditions.

Key Facts:

- The cemetery contains a single mass grave (Kameradengrab) holding the remains of 24,917 unidentified German soldiers.
- It is known as the 'Student Cemetery' because over 3,000 teenage student volunteers who died in the First Battle of Ypres (1914) are buried here.

Written Source:

"To no man does the earth mean so much as to the soldier. When he presses himself down upon her long and powerfully... then she is his only friend, his brother, his mother."

— **Erich Maria Remarque**, German soldier and author of *All Quiet on the Western Front*.

Hooze was the site of intense, close-quarters fighting. The opposing trenches were so close that soldiers could hear each other speaking. In July 1915, the British detonated a massive underground mine beneath the German lines, creating a massive crater.

Key Facts:

- The mine blast created a crater 120 feet wide and 20 feet deep.
- Soldiers in these trenches suffered terribly from 'trench foot' due to standing in freezing mud and water for days on end.

Written Source:

"The trench was a ribbon of earth, filled with freezing water, the stench of unburied bodies, and the constant, nerve-shredding crack of sniper fire."

— **Private Frank Richards**, Royal Welch Fusiliers

L3: Day 2: Friday 2nd October 2026

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

11:30

Supervised Lunch Stop

Stop in Ypres to purchase packed lunch and snacks.

22:00

Curfew & Room Checks

All students in rooms for the night.

09:00

Depart for Battlefield Sites

15:45

Passchendaele Museum (Zonnebeke)

Immersive museum tour and dugout experience.
[Visit official website.](#)

09:45

Sanctuary Wood & Preserved Trenches

Exploration of original trench systems (sturdy footwear advised).

Board coach for full day of guided study.

13:00

Tyne Cot British Cemetery

Guided visit to the world's largest Commonwealth war cemetery.

18:00

Evening Meal

Dinner at accommodation.

20:30

Return to Accommodation

Supervised free time.

08:00

Breakfast

Provided at accommodation.

1. Day 2 Itinerary

In April 1915, the Germans launched the first major poison gas attack of the war on the Western Front at St Julien. A heavy cloud of chlorine gas was released, devastating the French colonial troops and forcing the Canadian 1st Division to step in and hold the line.

Key Facts:

- Chlorine gas severely damaged the respiratory system, causing victims to suffocate.
- The earliest defense against the gas was holding cotton pads soaked in urine over the mouth, as the ammonia neutralized the chlorine.
- The memorial shows a soldier in a 'reverse arms' position, signifying mourning rather than victory.

Sanctuary Wood was initially a quiet area behind the lines where soldiers could rest (a sanctuary), but it eventually became part of the frontline. Today, it offers a rare look at an original, preserved trench system.

Key Facts:

- Trenches here were reinforced with corrugated metal ('elephant iron') to prevent collapse in the waterlogged soil.
- The shattered, dead trees preserved in the wood are a direct result of relentless artillery fire tearing the landscape apart.

Written Source:

"I died in hell—(They called it Passchendaele). My wound was slight, / And I was hobbling back; and then a shell / Burst slick upon the duck-boards: so I fell / Into the bottomless mud, and lost the light."

— **Siegfried Sassoon**, Memorial Tablet

14:15

Lijssenthoek Visitors Centre & Cemetery

Study of casualty clearing stations and battlefield medicine. [Visit official website.](#)

19:00

Menin Gate, Ypres

Attend the historic 20:00 Last Post Ceremony, including official wreath laying by nominated students. [Last Post Association.](#)

17:30

Return to Peace Village

Downtime and preparation for evening event.

09:15

The Brooding Soldier

Visit to the Canadian memorial at St Julien (First Gas Attack, 1915).



Tyne Cot Cemetery

Tyne Cot is the largest Commonwealth war cemetery in the world, reflecting the incomprehensible scale of the casualties during the Battle of Passchendaele (1917).

Key Facts:

- It contains 11,961 Commonwealth burials, but over 8,300 of these headstones belong to unidentified soldiers.
- The Cross of Sacrifice is built on top of a captured German concrete pillbox.
- The memorial wall at the back lists the names of nearly 35,000 men who died in the Salient after August 1917 and have no known grave.

Lijssenthoek was the largest evacuation hospital in the Ypres Salient. Located just out of artillery range, it received casualties directly from the frontline dressing stations.

Key Facts:

- It handled over 200,000 casualties during the war.
- The cemetery graves provide a timeline of hospital mortality, showing spikes during major offensives.
- Advances in treating infection happened here, including the Carrel-Dakin method of flushing wounds with antiseptics.
- Nurses also lost their lives here, such as Staff Nurse Nellie Spindler who was killed by a shell.



The Menin Gate, Ypres

The Menin Gate is a colossal memorial to the missing in Ypres. Millions of Allied soldiers marched through this spot on their way to the frontlines, and many never returned.

Key Facts:

- It bears the names of 54,000 soldiers who died before August 1917 and have no known grave.
- Every night at 8:00 PM since 1928, the local fire brigade plays the 'Last Post' bugle call to honor the fallen.

L4: Day 3: Saturday 3rd October 2026

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

13:30

Poperinge Town Hall

Visit to preserved death cells and military justice sites.

09:15

Menin Gate & Ramparts Walk

Daytime study of memorial panels and walk to Ypres Ramparts Cemetery.

11:20

Talbot House, Poperinge

Tour of the famous British soldiers' rest house and club. [Visit official website.](#)

14:30

Depart for Calais

08:00

Breakfast & Packing

Breakfast, room handover, and loading coach.

10:30

Ypres Town Square

Supervised visit to a traditional Belgian chocolatier.

17:50

Eurotunnel Crossing

Calais to Folkestone (arrives 17:30 UK time).

12:45

Lunch in Poperinge

Return journey to Eurotunnel terminal.

Supervised lunch stop in the town centre.

20:00 approx.

Return to School

Arrival back at Meoncross School for collection.

1. Day 3 Itinerary

The medieval ramparts of Ypres provided some of the only cover in the destroyed city. Soldiers dug deep into the ancient moated defenses to hide from the shelling. The Ramparts Cemetery is one of the most picturesque on the Western Front, built directly into the town's defenses.

Written Source:

"Who will remember, passing through this Gate, / The unheroic dead who fed the guns? / Who shall absolve the foulness of their fate..."

— **Siegfried Sassoon**, On Passing the New Menin Gate

Located in the town of Poperinge, safely behind the lines, Talbot House was set up by Army Chaplain Tubby Clayton as an 'Every Man's Club'. It was an oasis of sanity where soldiers could escape the psychological horror of the trenches.

Key Facts:

- Rank was completely ignored here; signs read 'Abandon Rank All Ye Who Enter Here'.
- Soldiers could drink tea, write letters, use the library, and attend services in the attic chapel.
- Over half a million men passed through its doors.

A stark contrast to Talbot House, the nearby Poperinge Town Hall contains the death cells and an execution post used by the British Army. Discipline was incredibly harsh, and shell shock was poorly understood by the high command.

Key Facts:

- Over 300 British and Commonwealth soldiers were executed by firing squad during the war, often for 'cowardice' or 'desertion'.
- Many of these men were actually suffering from severe psychological trauma (shell shock) caused by the relentless artillery bombardment.
- In 2006, the British Government issued a mass statutory pardon for all soldiers executed for military offenses during the First World War.

L5: Private T. J. Franklin

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Home

Stubbington Connection

Lived at Meadow Cottage, Chark

Memorial

Stubbington War Memorial

Commemorated in the village center.

Resting Place

Menin Gate, Ypres

Killed 29th April 1915 holding an exposed line on the Frezenberg Ridge.

1. The Life and Fall of Private T. J. Franklin

Service Number: 8560

Regiment: 1st Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

Born: Alverstoke, Hampshire, in about 1893.

Local Connection: He was the son of George Franklin (an Army Pensioner and farm labourer) and Mary Ann Jane Franklin. The family lived at Chark Cottage in Stubbington, and later moved to Meadow Cottage, Chark, Lee-on-the-Solent. By 1911, Thomas was serving in Wellington Lines, Aldershot.

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted at Gosport. He was deployed to the Western Front in August 1914, earning the 1914 Star. He was killed in action on **29th April 1915** during the Second Battle of Ypres. His battalion was holding an exposed section of the line on the Frezenberg Ridge (east of St Julien) to cover an Allied withdrawal, enduring intense German shelling and the first ever military poison gas attacks.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Ypres (Menin Gate) Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L6: Private W. Ayling

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Home

Stubbington Connection

Lived in Stubbington Lane; worked as a Baker Boy

Memorial

Stubbington War Memorial

Commemorated in the village center.

Resting Place

Menin Gate, Ypres

Killed 9th July 1915 during heavy trench mortar bombardment.

1. The Life and Fall of Private W. Ayling

Service Number: 9330

Rank: Private (commemorated on the Holy Rood Memorial Tablet as a Lance Corporal, though official war records register him as a Private).

Regiment: 1st Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

Born: About 1895 in Hindhead, Surrey.

Local Connection: He was the second son of Horace Ayling (a head cowman) and Annie Ayling. The family moved to Stubbington around 1907, residing in a crowded 13-person household in Stubbington Lane, where William worked as a local baker boy.

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted at Winchester. He crossed to France in August 1914, earning the 1914 Star. He was killed by shell fire on **9th July 1915** (only a few months after his battalion comrade, Private

Franklin). His company was heavily shelled and hit with trench mortars during an action to relieve captured enemy trenches north of Ypres.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Ypres (Menin Gate) Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L7: Private S. Muckett

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Resting Place Tyne Cot British Cemetery Killed 20th September 1917 during the Battle of Menin Road Ridge.	Memorial Stubbington War Memorial Commemorated in the village center.
Home Stubbington Connection Lived at Brown's Farm; worked as a Grocer's Errand Boy	

1. The Life and Fall of Private S. Muckett

Service Number: 12977
Rank: Private (listed as a Corporal on the Holy Rood Memorial, but registered as a Private in official war records).
Regiment: 15th (Service) Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment
Born: 26th December 1895 at Titchfield.

Local Connection: He was the son of William Muckett (a farm labourer) and Elizabeth Muckett. They lived at Pound Knap, Crofton, and Brown's Farm, Stubbington, where Sydney worked as a grocer's errand boy, before relocating to Melville Gate, Stubbington. His sister Louisa Annie and brother Frank both married into the local Rye family.

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted at Fareham in 1914. He was killed in action, aged 21, on **20th September 1917** during the Battle of Menin Road Ridge. His battalion went over the top south of Ypres, advancing rapidly under fire to clear a German strongpoint at Java Avenue.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L8: Private A. Rye

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Home

Stubbington Connection

Lived at Lower Crabthorne; Nurseryman

Resting Place

Tyne Cot British Cemetery

Killed 26th September 1917 at Polygon Wood.

Memorial

Stubbington War Memorial

Commemorated in the village center.

1. The Life and Fall of Private A. Rye

Service Number: 22926

Regiment: 14th Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

Born: 1897 at Forest Side, Sussex.

Local Connection: He was the youngest child of Charles Rye (a farm labourer) and Jane Rye. The family lived at Stroud Green, Stubbington. By 1911, Arthur was living at Lower Crabthorne, Hill Head, working as a local nurseryman. His sister Alice married Frank Muckett (brother of Private Sydney Muckett).

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted at Fareham. He was killed in action, aged 21, on **26th September 1917**—only nine days after his brother-in-law's brother, Sydney Muckett, was killed. His battalion attacked near the Menin Road, advancing through Tower Hamlets under heavy mist to consolidate their objectives.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium, on the exact same panels as Sydney Muckett (neither body was ever recovered).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L9: Lance Corporal A. Ward

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Memorial

Stubbington War Memorial

Commemorated in the village center.

Home

Stubbington Connection

Lived at Balmoral, Gosport Road

Resting Place

Tyne Cot British Cemetery

Killed 14th October 1918 advancing in thick mist.

1. The Life and Fall of Lance Corporal A. Ward

Service Number: 17568

Regiment: 15th (Hampshire Yeomanry) Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

Born: 1896 in Alverstoke.

Local Connection: He was the son of Hugh Ward (a Royal Navy Coastguard and yacht steward) and

Bertha Kathleen Ward. The family lived at 6 Coastguard Cottages, Hill Head, and later Balmoral, Gosport Road, Lee-on-the-Solent. His younger brother, Horace Vivian Ward, was also killed in action.

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted in Portsmouth. He fought on the Western Front, in Italy, and returned to France in March 1918. He was killed in action, aged 23, on **14th October 1918**—less than a month before the Armistice. During the final Allied advance from Gheluwe towards Courtrai, Belgium, his battalion advanced through thick mist under a harassing barrage to overcome German pillboxes.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L10: Private C. Warland

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Home Stubbington Connection Lived at Canford	Resting Place Tyne Cot British Cemetery Killed 4th October 1917 taking Juniper Trench.
Memorial Stubbington War Memorial Commemorated in the village center.	

1. The Life and Fall of Private C. Warland

Service Number: T/202335
Regiment: 3/4th Battalion, The Queen's (Royal West Surrey) Regiment
Born: 1897 at Richmond, Surrey.

Local Connection: He was the son of John Alfred Henry Warland (a sporting journalist, author, Secretary of the Lee-on-the-Solent Golf Club, and parish councillor) and Louise Clara Warland. The family lived at Canford, Lee-on-the-Solent.

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted in Richmond, Surrey. He was killed in action, aged 20, on **4th October 1917** during an assault south-east of Polygon Wood. His battalion advanced across the Polygonebeek marsh to capture Juniper Trench and a blockhouse under a continuous and heavy German artillery barrage.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L11: The Final Teacher Challenge

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Synthesize learning from various historical sites into a cohesive understanding of the Great War.

As we conclude our journey through the Ypres Salient, it is time to bring the stories of the fallen back home. Your final challenge is to choose one of the local heroes we investigated and write a short memorial speech that could be read aloud at the Stubbington War Memorial on Remembrance Sunday.

Your speech must:

- State who they were and where they lived.
- Describe the conditions they faced on the battlefield.
- Explain why their sacrifice, and the sacrifice of their generation, must never be forgotten.

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